(***iccha***), antipathies (*dvesha*), deliberate effort (*prayatna*), spiritual merit (***dharma***) and demerit (*adharma*), and personality traits (*samskara*).

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Matilal 1986

Atoms: in the Hindu ***Vaisheshika*** description of the cosmos, *atoms* (*anu/paramanu*) are the ultimately real raw material of the physical world. In the beginning, two form a pair, three pairs form a triplet, four triplets form a quadruplet and so on until there are entities of perceptible size (***dravya***) with persisting identities. The latter integrated wholes fall under natural kinds (***jati***, ***samanya***).

The existence of imperceptible atoms is inferred. Every visible object has parts. Anything partite is further divisible. But division cannot continue indefinitely since every entity would consist of an infinity of parts and an elephant would be the same size as a mustard seed. So the process must halt, at which point we have the basic, uncaused *atoms*, of which the elephant has more than the mustard seed.

When a newly produced clay pot is heated in a furnace, its complex atomic structure disintegrates and each of its black earth-atoms turns red. One colour is replaced by another. There can be no change in the *atoms* which recombine to form a new pot. In this process, the *atoms* are the underlying, material cause, and the heat is the efficient cause. (The ***Nyaya*** school holds that the change of colour applies to the pot as a whole that is neither destroyed nor replaced by a new one.)

The Buddhist ***Abhidharma*** tradition posits types of mental and material *atoms* (***dharma***) with unchanging natures (***svabhava***) as the basic ingredients of all macroscopic and experiential processes. They alone are objectively real: anything made of parts exists by convention or manufacture.